The elements of groups 13 to 18 are called p-block elements or representative elements and have a general electronic configuration ns^2, np^{1-6}. The elements of the group 16 and 17 are called chalcogens and halogens respectively. The elements of 18th group contain completely filled valence shell electronic configuration (ns^2, np^6) and are called inert gases or nobles gases. The elements of p-block have high negative electron gain enthalpies. The ionisation energies are higher than that of s-block elements. They form mostly covalent compounds and shows more than one oxidation states in their compounds.

The elements of the groups 3 to 12 are called d-block elements or transition elements with general valence shell electronic configuration ns^{1-2}, $(n-1)d^{1-10}$. These elements also show more than one oxidation state and form ionic, covalent and co-ordination compounds. They can form interstitial compounds and alloys which can also act as catalysts. These elements have high melting points and are good conductors of heat and electricity.

The lanthanides ($4f^{1-14}$, $5d^{0-1}$, $6s^2$) and the actinides ($5f^{0-14}$, $6d^{0-2}$, $7s^2$) are called f-block elements. These elements are metallic in nature and have high melting points. Their compounds are mostly coloured. These elements also show variable oxidation states.

Table 3.11 General outer electronic configuration of elements in groups:

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
ns^1	ns^2	$ns^2(n-1)d^1$	$ns^2(n-1)d^2$	$ns^2(n-1)d^3$	$ns^1(n-1)d^5$	$ns^2(n-1)d^5$	$ns^2(n-1)d^6$	$ns^2(n-1)d^7$	$ns^2(n-1)d^8$	$ns^1(n-1)d^{10}$	$ns^2(n-1)d^{10}$	ns^2np^1	ns^2np^2	ns^2np^3	ns^2np^4	ns^2np^5	ns^2np^6
s-block elements		d-block elements										p-block elements					
f-block elements		Lanthanides $4f^{1-14}\,5d^{0-1}\,6s^2$															
		Actinides $5f^{0-14}\,6d^{0-2}\,7s^2$															

Evaluate Yourself

3. Predict the position of the element in periodic table satisfying the electronic configuration $(n-1)d^2$, ns^2 where n=5

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